PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) and Security Operations

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Cyber Security Engineer with over five years of hands-on experience implementing, maintaining, and hardening enterprise-wide Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) and security operations platforms. I have delivered technical ownership of SIEM and Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) solutions across complex hybrid environments, including an 8,000-user Microsoft Defender deployment, and I bring deep expertise in CrowdStrike Falcon, Microsoft Sentinel, and Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) tooling. I am adept at reporting directly to senior stakeholders, working as part of small, high-impact security teams, and translating technical findings into clear risk narratives that drive informed decisions.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM and SOAR:** CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, Microsoft Sentinel (Kusto Query Language (KQL)), Splunk (Search Processing Language (SPL)), SOAR automation and playbook engineering
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent, Falcon EDR, Falcon Insight, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft Defender XDR
- **Threat Detection and Hunting:** Detection rule engineering, alert triage, threat hunting (MITRE ATT&CK framework), behavioural analytics
- **Incident Response:** NIST SP 800-61 lifecycle, containment, eradication, recovery, post-incident review
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Nessus, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck
- **Identity and Access Management (IAM):** Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) / Microsoft Entra ID, Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Cloud and Infrastructure:** Microsoft Azure, Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM) / Mobile Application Management (MAM), Check Point Harmony firewall, Mimecast, Tanium
- **Scripting:** PowerShell automation, security workflow scripting
- **Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), Center for Internet Security (CIS) Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL)
Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 – Present*

- Hold technical ownership of the university's SIEM and SOAR platforms, maintaining and hardening CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and Microsoft Sentinel to ensure high-fidelity detection coverage across all IT environments.
- Implement, configure, and tune Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR), identity protection, and email security tooling across an estate of approximately 8,000 users, encompassing Microsoft Defender for Endpoint, Defender for Identity, and Defender XDR.
- Engineer and maintain detection rules, alerting logic, and automated response playbooks, reducing mean time to detect (MTTD) and mean time to respond (MTTR) for security incidents.
- Lead incident response operations in line with the NIST SP 800-61 framework, coordinating investigation, containment, and post-incident review processes.
- Report to senior IT leadership, translating complex security findings into clear risk assessments and remediation plans aligned to organisational priorities.
- Drive continuous improvement of SIEM use-case libraries and threat detection content against MITRE ATT&CK framework tactics, techniques, and procedures (TTPs).
- Oversee Vulnerability Management programme using Tenable.io, Nessus, and Pentera BAS, prioritising and tracking remediation efforts across infrastructure and application layers.

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity *March 2022 – March 2025*

- Performed day-to-day administration and tuning of SIEM platforms including Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon, investigating and triaging security alerts and escalating true-positive incidents.
- Supported the deployment and configuration of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint and BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) across the university estate.
- Conducted threat hunting activities using KQL and CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, identifying lateral movement, credential abuse, and other attacker behaviours mapped to MITRE ATT&CK.
- Administered Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) / Microsoft Entra ID, Conditional Access policies, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), and Single Sign-On (SSO) configurations, hardening identity infrastructure against compromise.
- Assisted with vulnerability assessments using Tenable.io and AppCheck, tracking findings through to remediation and evidencing progress for Cyber Essentials Plus certification.
- Authored security runbooks and incident response playbooks, standardising analyst workflows and improving SOC operational maturity.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS / FinTech)
IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure *February 2021 – March 2022*

- Supported the design, deployment, and maintenance of security controls across cloud and on-premise infrastructure within a Software as a Service (SaaS) FinTech environment.
- Implemented endpoint protection, network firewall rules, and access control policies, contributing to overall reduction in attack surface.
- Managed IT infrastructure quality assurance processes and assisted with security audits, ensuring compliance with internal security standards and customer requirements.
- Provided technical support for identity management, endpoint hardening, and security monitoring tooling.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Delivered a full Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) rollout across approximately 8,000 users, achieving organisation-wide EDR coverage and significantly improving threat visibility.
- Engineered custom SIEM detection rules and SOAR playbooks that reduced alert-to-containment time by streamlining analyst workflows and automating initial triage steps.
- Led UAL's successful Cyber Essentials Plus certification, coordinating technical evidence gathering and remediation across multiple business units.
- Implemented BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) controls, reducing privileged account risk and providing comprehensive session recording for audit and compliance purposes.
- Built and maintained a threat-hunting capability aligned to MITRE ATT&CK, proactively identifying adversarial behaviours before they escalated to full incidents.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Hybrid (London / UK)